

NovaTech Solutions

Benefits & Compensation Policy

Salary, Bonuses, Health, Wellness & Perks

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Employee Benefits & Compensation Overview

NovaTech's total compensation philosophy is to pay at the 65th percentile of market for base salary and supplement this with competitive benefits, performance bonuses, and equity participation for senior roles. This document outlines all the components of your total rewards package.

1. Salary & Pay Review

Salaries are reviewed annually in January following the December performance appraisal. Increases are merit-based and tied to performance ratings.

Performance Rating	Typical Salary Increase	Bonus Multiplier
Exceptional	8% – 12%	1.5x target
Exceeds Expectations	5% – 8%	1.2x target
Meets Expectations	2% – 4%	1.0x target
Needs Improvement	0%	0.5x target
Unsatisfactory	0%	0x (no bonus)

Target bonus percentages: Individual Contributor 10%, Senior IC/Team Lead 15%, Manager 20%, Senior Manager 25%, Director+ 30%.

2. Health Insurance

All full-time employees and their immediate dependants (spouse + up to 3 children under 18) are covered under NovaTech's **comprehensive medical insurance plan** from Day 1 of employment. NovaTech pays 100% of the employee premium and 70% of the dependant premium.

- Annual coverage limit: OMR 50,000 per person.
- Network: All major hospitals and clinics in the GCC; international emergency cover included.
- Dental coverage: annual limit of OMR 500 (routine checkups, fillings, one crown per year).
- Optical coverage: annual limit of OMR 200 (frames + lenses or contact lenses; LASIK not covered).
- Mental health: up to 12 sessions per year with a licensed therapist; fully covered.
- Pre-existing conditions: covered after a 6-month waiting period.
- Prescription drugs: 80% covered for generic drugs; 60% for branded drugs.

3. Learning & Development Budget

NovaTech invests heavily in employee growth. Each employee receives an annual **Learning & Development (L&D;) budget of OMR 750 (approx. USD 1,950)** per calendar year.

- Eligible expenses: online courses (Coursera, Udemy, Pluralsight), professional certifications (AWS, PMP, CFA, etc.), conferences, and technical books.
- Approval: requests under OMR 150 are auto-approved. Above OMR 150 requires line manager sign-off.
- Employees leaving within 12 months of a company-funded certification (costing over OMR 200) may be required to repay a pro-rated amount.
- An additional OMR 500 company-sponsored 'stretch budget' is available for leadership courses for employees at Team Lead level and above.
- NovaTech also provides free access to LinkedIn Learning and internal knowledge-sharing sessions every Thursday.

4. Wellness & Lifestyle Benefits

We believe healthy employees are more productive and happier. NovaTech provides the following wellness benefits:

- **Gym reimbursement:** OMR 25/month toward a gym or fitness app subscription (Strava Premium, Apple Fitness+, etc.).
- **Mental health days:** 2 additional paid 'mental health days' per year, no questions asked.
- **Ergonomic equipment:** OMR 200 one-time budget for home office setup (chair, keyboard, monitor stand).
- **Employee Assistance Programme (EAP):** free, confidential counselling and financial advice available 24/7.
- **Parental support:** OMR 300 baby bonus paid on birth/adoption of a child.
- **Anniversary recognition:** a gift voucher of OMR 25 per year of service on work anniversary.

5. Equity & Long-Term Incentives

Employees at Senior Engineer / Senior Consultant level and above may be eligible for participation in the NovaTech Employee Stock Option Plan (ESOP). ESOP grants are made annually at the discretion of the Compensation Committee.

- Standard vesting schedule: 4 years with a 1-year cliff.
- Grant sizes range from 0.01% to 0.5% of the company depending on seniority.
- ESOP participants receive an annual statement in Q1 detailing vested and unvested options.
- Options expire 10 years from grant date or 90 days after leaving the company.

Note: ESOP eligibility and grant sizes are not guaranteed and are subject to change based on company financial performance and board approval.

6. Other Perks

- Phone allowance: OMR 15/month for employees required to use personal phones for work.
- Internet allowance for fully remote employees: OMR 20/month.
- Referral bonus: OMR 500 for successful employee referral hired and completing 3 months.
- Company events: annual team retreat, quarterly social events fully funded by NovaTech.
- Free snacks, coffee, and lunch on Wednesdays in all offices.